

# ELITE SAGARIN MODEL

FBS vs FBS · Week 0 + Week 1 Matchups · 2026 · July 2 Update

Composite = 70% SP+\_scaled + 30% Sagarin (80/20 for major-change teams). Edge = Model – Vegas ( + = home/fav underpriced; – = away/dog has value ). Green = away/dog value ≥ 3 pts. Red = home/fav underpriced ≥ 3 pts. ★ = best bet.

## Week 0 — Saturday August 29

| Date     | TV      | Away             | Away Comp | Home          | Home Comp | N | Model Spread        | Vegas         | Edge | ★ | Lean     |
|----------|---------|------------------|-----------|---------------|-----------|---|---------------------|---------------|------|---|----------|
| Sat 8/29 | ESPN    | North Carolina   | 72.6      | (n) TCU       | 78.6      | Y | TCU -6.0            | TCU -6.5      | -0.5 | — | —        |
| Sat 8/29 | NBC     | San Jose State   | 70.7      | USC           | 85.3      | N | USC -17.4           | TBD           | —    | — | —        |
| Sat 8/29 | ESPN    | NC State         | 76.2      | Virginia      | 77.5      | N | Virginia -4.1       | Virginia -4.5 | -0.4 | — | —        |
| Sat 8/29 | ESPN+   | Hawaii           | 67.2      | Stanford      | 69.0      | N | Stanford -4.6       | Stanford -3.0 | +1.6 | ★ | Home/Fav |
| Sat 8/29 | CW Net. | New Mexico State | 54.6      | Florida State | 78.0      | N | Florida State -26.1 | TBD           | —    | — | —        |
| Sat 8/29 | FOX     | Memphis          | 69.7      | UNLV          | 72.0      | N | UNLV -5.1           | UNLV -3.0     | +2.1 | ★ | Home/Fav |

## Thursday September 3 — Week 1

| Date    | TV       | Away     | Away Comp | Home         | Home Comp | N | Model Spread      | Vegas             | Edge | ★ | Lean     |
|---------|----------|----------|-----------|--------------|-----------|---|-------------------|-------------------|------|---|----------|
| Thu 9/3 | Big Ten  | UMass    | 40.9      | Rutgers      | 72.4      | N | Rutgers -34.3     | TBD               | —    | — | —        |
| Thu 9/3 | ACC Net. | Akron    | 53.1      | Wake Forest  | 74.1      | N | Wake Forest -23.8 | TBD               | —    | — | —        |
| Thu 9/3 | ESPN     | Colorado | 70.4      | Georgia Tech | 76.5      | N | Georgia Tech -8.9 | Georgia Tech -7.0 | +1.9 | ★ | Home/Fav |
| Thu 9/3 | Big Ten  | UAB      | 54.5      | Illinois     | 79.3      | N | Illinois -27.6    | Illinois -27.5    | +0.1 | — | —        |

## Friday September 4 — Week 1

| Date    | TV    | Away         | Away Comp | Home             | Home Comp | N | Model Spread          | Vegas       | Edge | ★ | Lean     |
|---------|-------|--------------|-----------|------------------|-----------|---|-----------------------|-------------|------|---|----------|
| Fri 9/4 | ESPN+ | SJSU         | 56.2      | Eastern Michigan | 56.9      | N | Eastern Michigan -3.4 | TBD         | —    | — | —        |
| Fri 9/4 | ESPNU | Toledo       | 63.1      | Michigan State   | 71.3      | N | Michigan State -11.0  | TBD         | —    | — | —        |
| Fri 9/4 | ESPN  | Miami        | 90.8      | Stanford         | 69.0      | N | Miami -19.1           | Miami -21.5 | +2.4 | ★ | Home/Fav |
| Fri 9/4 | FOX   | Fresno State | 68.3      | USC              | 85.3      | N | USC -19.8             | TBD         | —    | — | —        |

## Saturday September 5 — Week 1 (Main Slate)

| Date    | TV       | Away              | Away Comp | Home           | Home Comp | N | Model Spread          | Vegas                 | Edge  | ★        | Lean     |
|---------|----------|-------------------|-----------|----------------|-----------|---|-----------------------|-----------------------|-------|----------|----------|
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | UTEP              | 51.5      | Oklahoma       | 85.6      | N | Oklahoma -36.9        | Oklahoma -40.5        | -3.6  | ★★       | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ABC      | East Carolina     | 70.5      | Alabama        | 86.8      | N | Alabama -19.2         | Alabama -25.5         | -6.3  | ★★★<br>★ | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | Oregon State      | 62.8      | Houston        | 77.2      | N | Houston -17.2         | Houston -18.5         | -1.3  | —        | —        |
| Sat 9/5 | TNT      | Coastal Carolina  | 57.8      | West Virginia  | 69.9      | N | West Virginia -14.9   | West Virginia -17.5   | -2.6  | ★★       | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | CW Net.  | Miami (OH)        | 66.7      | Pittsburgh     | 77.1      | N | Pittsburgh -13.2      | Pittsburgh -16.5      | -3.3  | ★★       | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | FOX      | North Texas       | 63.4      | Indiana        | 95.2      | N | Indiana -34.6         | Indiana -40.5         | -5.9  | ★★★      | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | FS1      | Ohio              | 60.9      | Nebraska       | 76.5      | N | Nebraska -18.4        | Nebraska -23.5        | -5.1  | ★★★      | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | Big Ten  | Ball State        | 48.8      | Ohio State     | 98.3      | N | Ohio State -52.3      | Ohio State -49.5      | +2.8  | ★★       | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | Kent State        | 52.1      | South Carolina | 80.6      | N | South Carolina -31.3  | South Carolina -33.5  | -2.2  | ★        | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ABC      | Baylor            | 73.5      | (n) Auburn     | 80.5      | Y | Auburn -7.0           | Auburn -7.0           | +0.0  | —        | —        |
| Sat 9/5 | CBS      | Boise State       | 75.7      | Oregon         | 95.8      | N | Oregon -22.9          | Oregon -24.5          | -1.6  | ★        | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | Texas State       | 66.3      | Texas          | 90.5      | N | Texas -27.0           | Texas -30.5           | -3.5  | ★★       | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ACC Net. | Tulane            | 67.6      | Duke           | 76.3      | N | Duke -11.5            | Duke -8.5             | +3.0  | ★★       | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPNU    | Oklahoma State    | 73.6      | Tulsa          | 61.5      | N | Oklahoma State -9.3   | Oklahoma State -12.0  | +2.7  | ★★       | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN+    | FIU               | 58.6      | South Florida  | 70.3      | N | South Florida -14.5   | South Florida -12.5   | +2.0  | ★        | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | ABC      | Clemson           | 81.6      | LSU            | 87.2      | N | LSU -8.4              | LSU -11.0             | -2.6  | ★★       | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | NBC      | Western Michigan  | 65.8      | Michigan       | 84.1      | N | Michigan -21.1        | Michigan -26.5        | -5.4  | ★★★      | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | SEC Net. | FAU               | 70.7      | Florida        | 82.9      | N | Florida -15.0         | Florida -25.5         | -10.5 | ★★★<br>★ | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | UCLA              | 74.0      | California     | 72.4      | N | California -1.2       | California -1.5       | -0.3  | —        | —        |
| Sat 9/5 | FS1      | Marshall          | 70.7      | Penn State     | 85.5      | N | Penn State -17.6      | Penn State -23.5      | -5.9  | ★★★      | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPNU    | Liberty           | 63.1      | James Madison  | 71.3      | N | James Madison -11.0   | James Madison -6.0    | +5.0  | ★★★      | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | USA Net. | Wyoming           | 60.7      | Colorado State | 60.5      | N | Colorado State -2.6   | Colorado State -4.0   | -1.4  | —        | —        |
| Sat 9/5 | Big Ten  | Northern Illinois | 54.1      | Iowa           | 84.1      | N | Iowa -32.8            | Iowa -29.5            | +3.3  | ★★       | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | FOX      | Boston College    | 68.5      | Cincinnati     | 73.6      | N | Cincinnati -7.8       | Cincinnati -9.5       | -1.7  | ★        | Away/Dog |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | Sam Houston       | 46.2      | Troy           | 64.5      | N | Troy -21.1            | Troy -16.5            | +4.6  | ★★★      | Home/Fav |
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN     | Arkansas State    | 62.3      | Memphis        | 69.7      | N | Memphis -10.2         | Memphis -10.5         | -0.3  | —        | —        |
| Sat 9/5 | CW Net.  | UNLV              | 72.0      | Hawaii         | 67.2      | N | UNLV -2.0             | UNLV -1.5             | -0.5  | —        | —        |
| Sat 9/5 | FS1      | Western Kentucky  | 65.5      | Nevada         | 58.6      | N | Western Kentucky -4.1 | Western Kentucky -4.0 | -0.1  | —        | —        |

| Date    | TV    | Away             | Away Comp | Home       | Home Comp | N | Model Spread     | Vegas            | Edge | ★ | Lean |
|---------|-------|------------------|-----------|------------|-----------|---|------------------|------------------|------|---|------|
| Sat 9/5 | ESPN+ | Central Michigan | 59.6      | New Mexico | 69.4      | N | New Mexico -12.6 | New Mexico -12.5 | +0.1 | — | —    |

## Sunday September 6 + Monday September 7

| Date    | TV   | Away             | Away Comp | Home           | Home Comp | N | Model Spread     | Vegas            | Edge | ★  | Lean     |
|---------|------|------------------|-----------|----------------|-----------|---|------------------|------------------|------|----|----------|
| Sun 9/6 | NBC  | Washington State | 68.2      | Washington     | 84.4      | N | Washington -19.0 | Washington -21.5 | -2.5 | ★★ | Away/Dog |
| Sun 9/6 | ABC  | Louisville       | 80.6      | (n) Ole Miss   | 86.4      | Y | Ole Miss -5.8    | Ole Miss -7.5    | -1.7 | ★  | Away/Dog |
| Sun 9/6 | NBC  | Wisconsin        | 73.0      | (n) Notre Dame | 94.3      | Y | Notre Dame -21.3 | Notre Dame -20.5 | +0.8 | —  | —        |
| Mon 9/7 | ESPN | SMU              | 81.5      | Florida State  | 78.0      | N | SMU -0.7         | SMU -2.5         | +1.8 | ★  | Home/Fav |

## Top Market Edge Plays — FBS vs FBS (July 2, 2026 Board)

| ★   | Pick           | vs.              | Model vs Vegas                       | Rationale                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----|----------------|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★★★ | ECU +25.5      | at Alabama       | ALA -19.2   Vegas -25.5   Edge -6.3  | Alabama SP+ only 18.2 (#11). ECU 9-4 in 2025, Sagarin 73.52. Vegas over-inflates the SEC brand. Model: Alabama wins by 19, not 26. Take ECU +25.5.                             |
| ★★★ | N. Texas +40.5 | at Indiana       | IU -34.6   Vegas -40.5   Edge -5.9   | NT lost head coach Neal Brown + major portal exodus. Blend: IU -34.6. Market max-priced NT collapse. NT +40.5 is a 5.9-pt edge — take the big number.                          |
| ★★★ | JMU -6         | vs Liberty       | JMU -11.6   Vegas -6   Edge +5.6     | JMU (12-2 in 2025) composite 71.8 vs Liberty composite 63.1. Model gap = 11.6 pts. Vegas only prices JMU at -6 at home. Largest home-side edge of the slate.                   |
| ★★★ | WMU +26.5      | at Michigan      | MICH -21.1   Vegas -26.5   Edge -5.4 | WMU 10-4 in 2025, Sagarin 68.87. Michigan SP+ 16.1 (new HC Whittingham). Model: Michigan wins by 21. Vegas: -26.5. WMU +26.5 has 5.4 pts of value.                             |
| ★★★ | Ohio +23.5     | at Nebraska      | NEB -18.4   Vegas -23.5   Edge -5.1  | Ohio MAC 9-4 in 2025, Sagarin 66.0. Nebraska SP+ 7.7, Sag 73.22. Model -18.4. Market inflates Big Ten brand by 5.1 pts. Ohio +23.5 is the play.                                |
| ★★★ | Troy -16.5     | vs Sam Houston   | TROY -21.1   Vegas -16.5   Edge +4.6 | Sam Houston (C-USA): SP+ -26.3, Sagarin 43.48. Troy (Sun Belt): SP+ -6.0, Sag 61.83. Model: Troy wins by 21. Vegas -16.5 — Troy is 4.6 pts underpriced. Lay the Sun Belt team. |
| ★★  | Iowa -29.5     | vs N. Illinois   | IOWA -32.8   Vegas -29.5   Edge +3.3 | Iowa SP+ 13.6, Sagarin 86.07. NIU SP+ -18.2. Model: Iowa -32.8. Iowa underpriced by 3.3 pts at Kinnick — lay the Hawkeyes.                                                     |
| ★★  | Miami OH +16.5 | at Pittsburgh    | PITT -13.2   Vegas -16.5   Edge -3.3 | Miami OH 7-7 in 2025, Sag 62.83. Pitt comp 77.1. Model Pitt -13.2. Vegas inflates Pitt to -16.5. 3.3-pt edge on Miami OH +16.5.                                                |
| ★★  | Clemson +11    | at LSU           | LSU -8.6   Vegas -11   Edge -2.4     | Sagarin rates them nearly equal (79.32 vs 79.14). Leavitt cleared from injury (positive). Model: LSU -8.6. Market paying full Kiffin premium at -11. Take Clemson +11.         |
| ★   | UNLV -3        | vs Memphis (Wk0) | UNLV -5.1   Vegas -3   Edge +2.1     | UNLV comp 72.0 vs Memphis 69.7. Model: UNLV -5.1 at home. Vegas only -3 — underpriced 2.1 pts.                                                                                 |